

at RGEC.

Universities and Colleges

The state had just one university and 45 colleges in 1966, the number has now increased to nine universities; three deemed universities and more than 629 colleges. The state is proud to have the first women university in North India at Khanpur Kalan (Sonipat), which came up in 2006. Chhotu Ram State College of Engineering, Murthal, has been upgraded as Deen Bandhu Chhotu Ram University of Sciences and Technology so as to provide quality technical education to students. The government has recently upgraded Pt B.D.S. Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Sciences, Rohtak, as University of Health Sciences. In 2005, the state had Kurukshetra University, Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak, Chaudhary Devi Lal University, Sirsa, Chaudhary Charan Singh Haryana Agriculture University, Hisar and Guru Jambheshwar University of Science and Technology, Hisar. A private university, OP Jindal Global University, has also been set up recently.

A Central university is being set up at Jant Paali village in Mahendergarh; a Defence University is coming up in Gurgaon and two more private universities may soon start in Gurgaon, for which the Letter of Intent has already been issued.

National institutes

Various institutions of national importance, like Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT), Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Central Institute of Foreign Languages, and many more are also being established in the state. The Union Government has approved the IIM and 213 acres of land has been earmarked for it at Garnawati village of Rohtak.

The regional campus of the English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad is being set up in Meham to develop communication skills of the students of Haryana so as to make them globally competitive. English laboratories are also being set up in 25 government colleges, which are being developed as 'Centres of Excellence'. These English labs would enable students in terms of self-learning.

Maharshi Dayanand University has also signed an MoU with the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre, Mumbai; Board of Research in Nuclear Science,



From the current year nearly 2000 seats have been created in universities and colleges in job oriented fields like commerce, science, economics, business administration and computers. Several centres of advanced learning in upcoming fields like nanotechnology, forensic and biosciences are being introduced in higher education. Along with quantitative expansion in higher education, equal emphasis is on quality of education.

—Rajan Gupta

Secretary Education Haryana

Mumbai, and Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd, Mumbai, for establishing a Centre for Radio Ecology in the University. The Bhabha Atomic Research Centre has also given a grant of Rs 5.41 crore for the purpose.

Integrated campus

The Chief Minister, Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda recently laid the foundation stone of the first-of-its-kind state-level Integrated Institutional Campus for Fashion, Film, TV, Arts and

of Edusat (education through satellite) to provide quality education to students of schools, colleges and technical institutes.

Various other important decisions have been taken to provide the right direction to the higher education. The government has also constituted a committee to plan and monitor the larger policies relating to higher education system. The committee is guiding the Universities and the Higher Education Department with regard to the larger policy issues for growth and improvement of the higher education system in the state.

Focus has been laid on technical and computer education. The government proposes to open 40 government colleges during the 11th Five Year Plan. It has introduced the semester system and computer education is being made compulsory for all students in colleges. The government is also taking a lot of interest in improving the infrastructure in existing institutions. The Present government has established 176 new institutions of BE, MBA, MCA, B. Pharmacy and diploma courses from 2004-05 to 2008-09, with its annual intake increased from 16,945 to 44,910 respectively.

For improving the higher education system, the state proposes to increase the number of seats in futuristic courses like science, commerce and other job-oriented courses in colleges and universities.

Similarly, the concept of 'Centres of Excellence' has been introduced in state colleges and these will have all modern facilities of infrastructure, latest courses and well-qualified faculty.

The day is not far when Haryana will be recognised for quality education and that too at reasonable costs and at door steps. ■

"Haryana is the first state to set up a women university in North India, Bhagat Phool Singh Mahila Vishwavidyalaya at Khanpur Kalan, Sonipat where 33 per cent teaching jobs are reserved for women. We are encouraging women to be fully educated."

— Saroj Siwach, Commissioner Higher Education Haryana

Professional Studies at Rohtak. This campus, which will be constructed over an area of over 22 acres at a cost of about Rs 121 crore, will have a State Institute of Design and Fashion Technology, State Institute of Film and TV, State Institute of Fine Arts and State Institute of Professional Studies for Women. The four institutes would be modelled on apex institutions like National Institute of Fashion Technology, National Film and TV Institute, Pune and Delhi College of Arts, respectively.

Plans and policies

The state government had observed 2008 as the Year of Education to focus on providing education to the students in consonance with the changing scenario. Haryana has the largest network